

# ACME GENERAL INSURANCE COMPANY LIMITED

## Internal Circular AGI/CL/2026/09 - Revised Claim Handling Timelines

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Effective from 01/07/2026 | Applies to all claims offices and the TPA

This Circular is issued to all claims processing offices, branch offices and the empanelled Third Party Administrator. It takes effect from 1 July 2026 and must be read together with the Standard Operating Procedure AGI/SOP/CLAIMS/2024/04.

### SECTION 1 - REVISED TURNAROUND TIMES

#### 1.1 Background

A review of claims handling during the preceding financial year identified delays concentrated in the pre-authorisation query cycle and in the collection of deficiency documents for reimbursement claims. The following turnaround times are revised with immediate effect.

#### 1.2 Revised Timelines

| Activity                                 | Previous | Revised             |
|------------------------------------------|----------|---------------------|
| Pre-authorisation - planned admission    | 6 hours  | 4 hours             |
| Pre-authorisation - emergency admission  | 2 hours  | 1 hour              |
| Enhancement of approved amount           | 4 hours  | 2 hours             |
| Deficiency letter after document receipt | 15 days  | 7 days              |
| Settlement after last necessary document | 30 days  | 30 days (unchanged) |

### SECTION 2 - MANDATORY CLAUSE REFERENCING

#### 2.1 Requirement

With effect from the date of this Circular, every repudiation and every partial settlement must record the applicable rejection reason code and the specific clause of the Policy Wording relied upon. A repudiation letter that states a reason without a clause reference must not be despatched.

#### 2.2 Rationale

Where a policyholder escalates a decision to the Grievance Officer or to the Insurance Ombudsman, the Company must be able to demonstrate the basis of the decision by reference to the wording in force on the date of loss. A reason recorded without a clause reference cannot be defended.

### SECTION 3 - APPLICABLE POLICY VERSION

#### 3.1 Date of Loss Governs

Assessors are reminded that the Policy Wording applicable to a claim is the wording in force on the date of admission, and not the wording current at the time of assessment. Following the release of Family Health Optima Version 3.2 on 1 April 2024, claims with a date of loss before that date continue to be governed by Version 2.8, including the forty-eight month pre-existing disease waiting period and the room rent cap of four thousand rupees per day.

### **3.2 Common Error**

The most frequently observed assessment error in the preceding quarter was the application of the revised thirty-six month pre-existing disease waiting period to claims governed by Version 2.8. All such assessments completed since 1 April 2026 are to be reviewed and corrected within thirty days.

## **SECTION 4 - ACKNOWLEDGEMENT**

All claims processing offices must acknowledge receipt of this Circular and confirm that processing staff have been briefed, within seven days of the effective date.